Mahal of Fatehpur Sikri to Muhammad Gauth's* tomb, to the tomb of Sher Shah Sur, amongst others. Perhaps the most perplexing and unusual element of the mausoleum is that there is no superstructure, no classic resplendent Timurid dome. Instead, there is a flat courtyard pavilion on the roof of the monument, fashioned entirely from a single block of white marble, inscribed with the ninety-nine names of Allah. In the centre of the courtyard lies Akbar's cenotaph, which marks the exact position of the Padshah's actual grave in a crypt far below.

Jahangir noted in his memoir that in the third year of his reign, he visited the construction site of the mausoleum and was displeased with what he saw. He said that he then consulted with other architects and remodelled the building and spent large sums of money on having it completed. This would explain the white marble pavilion at the top of the structure, marble being Jahangir's favourite material. Whether the structure was intended to ever have a superstructure is unknown but it is possible that it was meant to be covered with a huge tent, the contemporary traveller William Finch alluding in his writings to just such a 'rich tent'. If it was instead unfinished, then Jahangir was nonetheless proud of this building:

> I had intended it to be such that world travelers wouldn't be able to point to another such building in all the world.

A narrow, cool, and dark corridor leads deep into a crypt which contains the actual grave of the Padshah. This crypt chamber once contained the very best and most extensive of the mausoleum decorations, all of which were meant to extol the glory of the dead Padshah. The chamber would have been well-lighted by lamps which would have been kept burning constantly. The paintings included Christian imagery, such as a crucifix with the Virgin Mary and Child, and a depiction of St Ignatius, while the 'ceiling of the dome were (covered with) great angels and cherubim and many other painted figures'. If we know about some of the details of these decorations it is because a contemporary traveller, Niccolao Manucci, saw the mausoleum and described it. Today they are lost to us, for Akbar's great-grandson, Aurangzeb, had all these paintings white-washed, to efface the offending human figures.

The crypt would have been richly furnished with fine carpets, gold and silver plates, and would have displayed the books, sword, weapons, and armour of Akbar. But in 1691, while Padshah Aurangzeb was far away in